[photo]

LEOPARD TORTOISE

Stigmochelys pardalis

HAY + GRASSES — Grazer (with limited greens)

WHAT THIS ANIMAL IS: African grassland grazing tortoise

SITES: Houston · SAA · Other

3-SEC CHECK Do I see grass hay — and NO fruit?

STANDARD DIET — HEALTHY ANIMALS ONLY

Excludes sick / vet-care / special-diet animals

Covers ~95% of daily feedings. For the remaining 5%, use training and observation within sound science. Unsure — Pause. Ask. Escalate.

MORNING FEED-OUT

Whole hay pile. Greens in large leaves, stems intact. No chopping.

APPROX DAILY: Hay ad-lib + ~150–250 g fresh greens

ENCOUNTER / ENRICHMENT PORTION

Pulled fistfuls of hay or whole leafy stems for hand-feeding. Drawn from daily allocation.

CORRECT

Grass hay + pasture grasses dominant

Timothy hay

Grass hay

Browse branches

Dandelion greens

Mulberry leaves

Collard greens

WRONG — FIX IMMEDIATELY

Fruit · Commercial tortoise pellets · High-protein greens

Apple

Banana

Kale

Herbivore pellets

SIMPLE BUILD

- 80% grass hay + fresh grasses
- 15% coarse greens (dandelion, mulberry)
- 5% browse
- NO FRUIT

PREP RULE

Whole hay pile. Fresh grasses cut long. Greens whole. NO fruit — leopard tortoises are strict grazers; fruit causes diarrhea and shell issues.

MATCH THE BOWL — DO NOT INTERPRET.

No photo = feeding not complete. · No substitutions without approval. · Unsure → Pause → Ask → Escalate.

Source: AZA Chelonian TAG + Sulcata/Leopard nutrition guidelines · Body-text extraction
LIFE Diet Governance System · v2026.04.23 · Match the bowl. Don't interpret.